Northstar Components

Employee Handbook — Retrieval Quality Test Edition

> **Fictional training document** created specifically for testing a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) application. All company names, policies, contacts, and figures in this document are invented for practice and must not be treated as real company policy.

Document control

Field	Value
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Assembly facility	Nashik, Maharashtra
Purpose	Controlled employee-policy reference for internal questions

How to use this test edition

Use this PDF to test document parsing, page-aware chunking, embedding generation, vector storage, retrieval ranking, threshold filtering, and grounded answer generation. Facts are distributed across sections so questions can target exact details as well as paraphrased meanings.

Your current chunker splits each page separately and defaults to 500 words with 50-word overlap. Results depend on PDF text extraction, chunk boundaries, embedding model, top_k, and similarity threshold.

1. Company Overview

About Northstar Components

Northstar Components is a fictional mid-sized manufacturer of precision components for industrial equipment. Its main office is in Pune, Maharashtra, and its assembly facility is in Nashik. The company began operations in 2014. Its internal employee handbook is version 3.2, effective 1 April 2026.

Operating principles

The company uses four operating principles: safety first, customer commitments, continuous improvement, and responsible use of information. Employees are expected to report safety risks promptly and protect company and customer information.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard schedule

The standard office schedule for administrative employees is Monday through Friday, 9:30 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. The normal lunch break is 1:00 p.m. to 1:30 p.m. Production shift timings are published separately by the plant manager and may differ from office timings.

Attendance correction

Employees who notice a missing or incorrect attendance entry must submit an attendance correction request in the People Portal within three working days. Their line manager must approve the request before HR updates the attendance record.

Remote work

Eligible corporate employees may request up to two remote-work days per week, subject to manager approval and team coverage. Remote work is not automatic, and production-floor roles are not eligible under this policy.

3. Leave and Holidays

Casual leave

Full-time employees receive 12 days of casual leave per calendar year. Casual leave should normally be requested at least two working days in advance. Emergency requests may be submitted on the same day, with manager notification as soon as practical.

Sick leave

Employees receive 8 days of sick leave per calendar year. A medical certificate is required for sick leave lasting more than two consecutive working days. The employee should inform the manager before the shift begins whenever possible.

Earned leave

Employees accrue earned leave at 1.5 days for every completed month of service, up to a maximum balance of 30 days. Earned leave requests should normally be submitted at least seven calendar days before the first day of leave.

Public holidays

The company publishes an annual holiday calendar in the People Portal. The 2026 calendar lists 10 company holidays. If a public holiday falls on a scheduled production day, the plant manager communicates the shift arrangement.

Leave approval

Casual and earned leave require line-manager approval. Sick leave must be reported promptly and is recorded by HR; the medical-certificate rule still applies where relevant.

4. Compensation and Payroll

Payroll date

Monthly salaries are normally credited on the last working day of each month. If a bank holiday or system outage affects processing, Payroll will communicate the revised credit date through the employee portal.

Salary slips

Employees can download salary slips from the People Portal under My Documents. Payroll queries should be raised through the Payroll Helpdesk within 30 calendar days of the salary credit date.

Salary revision

Annual salary reviews are usually conducted in July. A review does not guarantee an increase; decisions depend on role expectations, performance, business conditions, and budget approval.

Expense reimbursement

Approved business travel expenses must be submitted in the Expense Portal within 15 calendar days of the trip's completion. Receipts are required for individual expenses above ■1,000. The manager approves the claim before Finance processes it.

5. Benefits and Support

Health insurance

The company provides a group medical insurance policy for eligible employees and their enrolled dependants. Coverage details, exclusions, and claim instructions are available from HR. This handbook does not specify the policy's sum insured.

Learning allowance

Eligible employees may claim up to ■18,000 per financial year for approved job-related courses or certifications. Prior manager approval is required, and the claim must include proof of payment and completion.

Employee support

Employees can contact the People Operations team through the People Portal. The standard response target is two working days, excluding public holidays. Urgent safety concerns must be reported to the plant safety desk or the manager immediately.

6. Information Security

Passwords and authentication

Employees must use unique passwords and multi-factor authentication for company accounts. Passwords must not be shared in chat, email, or documents. Suspected account compromise must be reported to the IT Service Desk immediately.

Data handling

Customer files classified as Restricted must be stored only in approved company repositories. They must not be copied to personal cloud storage or sent to personal email accounts. Access should be granted according to job responsibility.

Phishing

Employees should report suspicious emails using the Report Phishing button in the mail client. They must not open unexpected attachments or enter credentials on pages reached through suspicious links.

Device security

Company laptops must use disk encryption and screen lock. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT Service Desk within one hour of discovery.

7. Procurement and Vendor Management

Purchase requests

Purchase requests below ■25,000 require approval from the department manager. Requests from ■25,000 through ■2,00,000 require department-manager and Finance approval. Requests above ■2,00,000 require department-manager, Finance, and Procurement Head approval.

Vendor onboarding

A new vendor must submit its tax registration details, bank proof, and signed code of conduct. Procurement validates the documents before the vendor is activated in the purchasing system.

Invoice processing

Invoices should reference the purchase order number and goods-receipt number. Complete and matched invoices are targeted for payment within 30 calendar days. Disputed invoices are placed on hold until the issue is resolved.

8. Travel and Safety

Travel booking

Business travel must be approved by the line manager before booking. Employees should use the company's approved travel desk unless an exception is authorized by Finance.

Local travel claims

Taxi and local transport claims require date, business purpose, and receipt where available. Claims without a business purpose may be returned for clarification.

Incident reporting

Workplace injuries, near misses, and unsafe conditions must be reported to the supervisor immediately and entered in the Safety Portal before the end of the shift. The safety team reviews reported incidents each working day.

Emergency contacts

For a medical emergency at the Pune office, contact the building security desk at extension 220. For a production-floor emergency in Nashik, activate the nearest alarm and notify the plant emergency coordinator.

9. Performance and Development

Review cycle

Formal performance reviews take place twice each year, in June and December. Employees prepare a self-review, and the manager records feedback and development goals.

Promotion consideration

Promotion decisions consider demonstrated capability at the next level, sustained performance, role availability, and approval from the department head. Time in role alone does not guarantee promotion.

Training records

Completed company-sponsored training must be recorded in the Learning Portal within five working days. Employees should retain certificates until the record is confirmed.

10. Facilities and Administration

Visitor access

Visitors must register at reception, wear a visitor badge, and remain accompanied in controlled areas. Hosts are responsible for collecting visitor badges before departure.

Asset return

Employees leaving the company must return laptops, access cards, and other assigned assets to IT or Facilities by their final working day. HR completes exit clearance after receiving the required confirmations.

Office supplies

Routine office-supply requests are submitted through the Facilities Portal. Requests for specialized tools or production materials must use the procurement process.

11. Quality and Continuous Improvement

Non-conformance

Products or processes that do not meet specification must be logged in the Quality Portal within one working day of discovery. Employees must not bypass inspection controls to meet a shipment deadline.

Corrective action

The process owner must propose a corrective-action plan within five working days after a non-conformance is assigned. Quality verifies completion before the issue is closed.

Improvement ideas

Employees can submit improvement ideas through the Continuous Improvement Portal. The review committee meets on the second Wednesday of each month and records accepted ideas for follow-up.

12. Records and Document Control

Document retention

Finance transaction records are retained for seven years. Employee attendance records are retained for three years. Restricted customer documents follow the retention period stated in the applicable customer contract.

Controlled copies

The current approved handbook is published in the People Portal. Downloaded copies are uncontrolled; employees should verify the version before relying on a saved copy.

Policy questions

Questions about interpreting this handbook should be sent to People Operations. Where a law or signed employment agreement conflicts with a handbook summary, HR and Legal review the specific case.

Appendix A — Quick Policy Reference

Topic	Key fact
Casual leave	12 days per calendar year
Sick leave	8 days per calendar year; certificate after more than 2 consecutive working days
Earned leave	1.5 days per completed month; maximum balance 30 days
Remote work	Up to 2 days per week for eligible corporate employees, with approval
Learning allowance	Up to ■18,000 per financial year for approved job-related learning
Expense deadline	Within 15 calendar days after business trip completion
Device loss	Report within 1 hour of discovery
Training record	Within 5 working days after completion
Non-conformance	Log within 1 working day of discovery
Corrective-action plan	Within 5 working days after assignment
Finance records	Retain for 7 years
Attendance records	Retain for 3 years